



THE FIRST TRIUMPH OF PAGANINI

This painting by Annibale Gatti, c. 1890, is thought to show the young composer at one of his performances at the court in Lucca at the start of the 19th century.

Pursuit of fame and glory

Niccolò had studied violin briefly in Genoa; in Parma, the celebrated violinist Alessandro Rolla said the boy was so talented that there was little he could teach him. But Paganini's desire for fame was such that he subjected himself to a grueling routine, often practicing his own compositions on the violin for many hours a day.

In 1801, aged 19, Paganini began composing his 24 Caprices for Solo Violin (not published until 1820)—which became his most